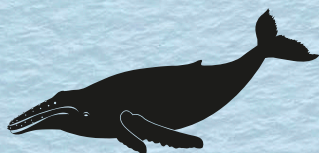


A HUMPBAC WHALE CAN SWALLOW UP TO 4 TONS OF PREY EACH DAY



WHALE SONGS CAN BE HEARD UP TO 20 MILES (30 KM) AWAY

Icy feeding grounds
In the cold waters around the Arctic, humpback whales feed on a mixture of small animals—including fishes such as herring and pollack, and shrimplike crustaceans such as krill.

Pacific routes

Whales that feed in the waters around Alaska follow two migration routes—either across the Pacific to breed in Hawaii or along the US coast to California.

Farthest travelers

Whales migrating up the west coast of South America travel a record-breaking distance for this species—crossing up to 5,160 miles (8,300 km) between Central America and Antarctica.

Northern Indian Ocean

Whales only migrate within one hemisphere. In the northern Indian Ocean—which is north of the equator—whales can't migrate further north, so they live here year round.

Heading north

Whales in the Southern Ocean begin their northward migration around May to breeding grounds in the tropics, such as around the coast of eastern Africa and Madagascar.

Antarctic waters

The cold Southern Ocean around Antarctica teems with krill—a shrimplike crustacean that drifts in enormous swarms. Krill supplies almost all the food of whales feeding here.

Raising young

After a pregnancy lasting nearly a year, a humpback whale gives birth to a single calf that already weighs almost a ton. The baby grows quickly on more than 90 lb (40 kg) of milk every day, and stays with its mother for up to a year.



KEY

Feeding grounds
Breeding grounds

Year-round population
Migration routes